CSIS AUSTRALIA CHAIR

Australia Daily Brief

Monday, November 9, 2026

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RE: Taiwan ends all aid and LNG purchases to PNG · NZ coalition majority rests on 399,000 uncounted votes · One Nation draws level with Labor nationally · Albanese to meet a 'diminished' Trump · Victoria Barracks sale scrapped

ASX 200	AUD/USD	NZX 50	NZD/USD
9,030	0.6903	13,974	0.5611
+1.96%	-1.39%	+2.32%	-0.14%

IN THIS ISSUE Top Stories · Overnight · Stat · AUKUS · Pacific · New Zealand · Canberra · Markets · Upcoming · The Wire

TODAY AT A GLANCE

1. Taiwan terminated all aid and technical cooperation in Papua New Guinea and halted LNG purchases, completing the rupture Port Moresby triggered in July by upholding the one-China policy.
2. New Zealand's governing coalition holds 67 of 131 seats, one above the threshold, with 399,000 special votes uncounted and the two major parties separated by 3,650 party votes.
3. Roy Morgan put One Nation within one point of Labor's national primary vote as the Albanese government abandoned the sale of four heritage defence sites.

TOP STORIES

CHINA-PACIFIC

Taiwan completes aid and LNG cutoff to Papua New Guinea

Taiwan's Foreign Ministry confirmed it has closed its Port Moresby office, withdrawn all stationed personnel, and terminated "all technical cooperation and aid programs in Papua New Guinea". Taipei said Port Moresby had "renewed its unilateral demands" for the Taipei Economic Office's staff to leave within a specified timeframe. The decision follows the July announcement by PNG Foreign Minister **Justin Tkatchenko** that Prime Minister **James Marape**'s government would honour the one-China policy, and extends to a halt on Taiwanese purchases of PNG liquefied natural gas.

per RNZ Pacific: "Taiwan shuts Papua New Guinea office, cuts all aid and halts LNG purchases" · also Islands Business

NZ-POLITICS

New Zealand coalition's majority rests on 399,000 uncounted votes

Preliminary results give **Christopher Luxon**'s coalition 67 of 131 seats, one above the 66 needed to govern, after a record 11-seat overhang inflated Parliament. National's party vote entitles it to 35 MPs, but leads in 42 electorates add seven overhang seats, while Te Pati Maori's five electorate wins against a one-seat party vote add four more. An estimated *399,000* special votes, roughly one in seven cast, remain uncounted and have historically favoured the left.

per RNZ: "How 399,000 votes could cost Christopher Luxon his majority" · also Reuters

AU-POLITICS

One Nation draws level with Labor in new national poll

Roy Morgan called the federal contest "too close to call", with Labor on a primary vote of 25.5 percent, One Nation on *24.5 percent*, and the Liberal-National Coalition third on 22 percent. The figures landed as Labor frontbencher **Murray Watt** accused One Nation of being a party "wracked by chaos and division", after the Nine Network reported its former national campaign director saying **Gina Rinehart** is dictating party strategy.

per Roy Morgan Research: "Federal Election is now 'too close to call' as ALP (25.5%) holds narrow primary vote lead over One Nation (24.5%) and L-NP Coalition (22%)"

US-AUSTRALIA

Albanese to meet a 'diminished' Trump on summit run

Anthony Albanese said on Monday he would engage with a diminished **Donald Trump** "respectfully and diplomatically" when the two are mooted to meet this month, as he sets off on a run of international summits after the US midterms. Separately, ABC reported Albanese has delayed his departure for COP to chair budget meetings in Canberra.

per SMH Federal Politics (Natassia Chrysanthos): "Albanese to come face to face with Trump as he sets off on summit blitz"

OVERNIGHT

AU-DEFENSE

Government scraps sale of four heritage defence sites · ABC News

Four heritage-listed Defence sites, including Sydney's Victoria Barracks, will stay in public hands after a public backlash, with the Albanese government insisting the reversal is not a backdown. **Richard Marles** said keeping the four sites will not affect the budget. Dozens of other Defence sites identified in an independent estate audit in February remain under consideration for sale.

AU-FOREIGN-POLICY

COP31 scrutiny mounts over Australia's fossil fuel exports · ABC News

Australia leads negotiations at the UN climate conference over the next fortnight while facing scrutiny at home, with ABC reporting emissions from Australian fossil fuel exports have almost doubled over the past two decades. Vanuatu's Climate Change Minister **Ralph Regenvanu** said Australia "is not doing enough" and remains "a major producer of fossil fuels".

AU-POLITICS

Victorian Labor falls to third place behind One Nation · Guardian Australia

A DemosAU/PremierNational poll put Victorian Labor's primary vote at an all-time low of *18 percent*, seven points down, behind the Coalition on 33 percent and One Nation on 21 percent, with the Greens up three to 17 percent. Deputy Premier **Ben Carroll** refused to be drawn on the figures. The state election falls on November 28.

PACIFIC-DIPLOMACY

Pacific climate facility $300 million short of year-end target · ABC Pacific

Pacific Islands Forum Chair and Palau President **Surangel Whipps Jr** said the region has raised *$200 million* for its climate disaster response facility and remains $300 million short of the end-of-year target, with the Pacific now approaching wealthy Gulf states for funding. Trade unions across the region are pressing for a Just Transition Mechanism at COP31.

TRADE-ECONOMY

Australian beef piles up in Chinese warehouses amid quota scramble · AFR

Competition between Australian and South American exporters means China's beef import quotas for next year could be filled before Easter, the AFR reports, leaving Australian product accumulating in Chinese warehouses.

STAT OF THE DAY

399,000

uncounted New Zealand special votes

About one vote in seven remains uncounted, and specials have historically favoured the left, leaving the coalition's one-seat majority unresolved for weeks.

RNZ

AUKUS WATCH

PILLAR 1 · ASPI STRATEGIST

ASPI says online reaction to the AUKUS inquiry overstates real opposition

The ASPI Strategist argues the report of the "so-called independent public inquiry" into AUKUS and the social media reaction to it reveal more about the state of Australian public debate than about public opinion. The inquiry, which called for the submarine pact to be scrapped, was covered in this brief on November 4.

PILLAR 1 · AUSTRALIAN DEFENCE MAGAZINE

Australian Defence Magazine examines Defence's submarine insurance policy

Australian Defence Magazine reports on what it calls Defence's submarine insurance policy, published as debate continues over the affordability and timing of the nuclear-powered submarine program.

PACIFIC WIRE

SOLOMON ISLANDS · ISLANDS BUSINESS

Solomon Islands government proposes constitutional reforms

The Solomon Islands government is proposing constitutional reforms to address political instability and strengthen parliamentary governance, Islands Business reports. Prime Minister **Jeremiah Manele** hands the Pacific Islands Forum chair to Palau this cycle.

FIJI · ISLANDS BUSINESS

Fiji welcomes Quad support for port upgrades

Fiji has welcomed continued support from Australia, India, Japan and the United States to modernise its port infrastructure and strengthen its maritime capacity, Islands Business reports.

FIJI · RNZ PACIFIC

Fijian minister says constitution vote costs her job either way

Minister for Women, Children and Social Protection **Sashi Kiran** said she will lose her Cabinet post whichever way she votes on the Constitution (Amendment) Bill: her NFP party has directed members to oppose it, while Prime Minister **Sitiveni Rabuka** has said he will expel any minister who votes against. Rabuka has delayed the third reading by at least a month after NFP and SODELPA came out against the bill, which passed its second reading on 2 October.

PAPUA NEW GUINEA · RNZ PACIFIC

Marape unveils 'no more than three children' family planning policy

Prime Minister **James Marape** said Papua New Guinea will introduce a National Family Planning Policy encouraging families to have no more than three children. The National Statistics Office puts the population at *10.18 million* and annual growth at 2.6 percent, or more than 180,000 people a year. Marape announced the policy at the newly opened Dr Kaven Memorial Hospital at Palmalmal Station in East New Britain Province.

TUVALU · ISLANDS BUSINESS

Tuvalu and Nauru forecasters train for outer-island El Nino warnings

Meteorological staff in Tuvalu and Naoero are working to deliver forecasts and hazard messaging to communities beyond the main island as El Nino conditions shape weather patterns, Islands Business reports.

PAPUA NEW GUINEA · ABC PACIFIC

UPNG students demand government oversight of bullying inquiry

Students at the University of Papua New Guinea are demanding the reinstatement of their former Vice-Chancellor, who abruptly resigned and left the country citing bullying by the university's Chancellor, and want the government to oversee the inquiry.

NEW ZEALAND

NZ-POLITICS · RNZ

Just 3,650 party votes separate New Zealand's two major parties

More than 2.4 million party votes have been counted, with Labour on 710,330 and National on 706,680, a gap of *3,650*. The margin was about 1,500 before 10pm on election night, prompting The Post's political editor **Henry Cooke** to note the difference between the two major parties could fit inside Auckland's St James Theatre.

NZ-POLITICS · RNZ

Opportunity leader says she will call Luxon if he does not call her

Qiulae Wong, whose Opportunity Party entered Parliament for the first time, said she expects **Christopher Luxon** to call and will pick up the phone herself within days if he does not. She has had congratulatory calls from Labour's **Chris Hipkins** and the Greens' **Chloe Swarbrick**, with no discussion of governing arrangements, and will leave negotiations until after the final count.

NZ-POLITICS · REUTERS

Reuters reads New Zealand's result as a desertion of the major parties

Reuters reports New Zealand voters deserted the main parties, echoing a global shift away from the political establishment, with Luxon on course for a second term but a weaker hand in coalition.

NZ-POLITICS · BLOOMBERG

Luxon faces a deadline in his search for a finance minister

Bloomberg reports New Zealand's prime minister faces a deadline in selecting a finance minister, with new lawmakers already arriving at Parliament while the shape of the government remains unresolved.

CANBERRA POLITICS

AU-POLITICS · ABC NEWS

Resolve puts voter trust in Albanese at 20 percent

The Resolve Political Monitor finds only *20 percent* of voters say they trust **Anthony Albanese**, while the Redbridge poll for the AFR has Labor support at a record low and the Coalition surging. ABC's **Patricia Karvelas** writes it could be a matter of when, not if, **Andrew Hastie** becomes opposition leader.

AU-POLITICS · SMH FEDERAL POLITICS

Albanese ally tells colleagues to stop leaking against Chalmers

An ally of the prime minister called on colleagues to stop leaking against and undermining Treasurer **Jim Chalmers**, as pressure grows on Labor to combat inflation. The relationship between Albanese and his treasurer has come into the spotlight.

AU-POLITICS · SMH FEDERAL POLITICS

Investigators flag prime minister's staffing powers

Albanese has drawn criticism over his provision of highly paid staff in Parliament, with suggestions the corruption watchdog could investigate, the Sydney Morning Herald reports.

AU-POLITICS · ABC NEWS

ABC: Labor would have to change tactics under a Hastie-led Coalition

ABC analysis argues Labor's approach to the opposition would need to shift if **Andrew Hastie** takes the Liberal leadership, published alongside polling showing the Coalition gaining ground.

AU-POLITICS · AFR

AFR says Future Made in Australia has delivered $0 to business

Future Made in Australia, central to Labor's productivity agenda, has delivered nothing to business so far, with implementation moving slowly, the AFR reports.

AU-POLITICS · ABC NEWS

Conservation Council seeks ACT data centre moratorium

The Conservation Council is calling for a moratorium on new data centre developments in the ACT until tougher rules are in place, citing increasing concerns about the impact on Canberra's water supply and electricity grid.

BUSINESS AND ECONOMY

TRADE-ECONOMY · AFR

RBA says AI will hit jobs but stay inflation neutral

The Reserve Bank's chief economist said artificial intelligence will affect employment while leaving long-term inflation broadly neutral, pointing to evidence that technology shifts are already softening graduate hiring in

exposed sectors.

TRADE-ECONOMY · THE AUSTRALIAN

ANZ posts $7.6 billion profit, warns of more cuts if growth slows

ANZ chief executive **Nuno Matos** delivered an annual profit of *$7.6 billion* and warned of further cuts should the Australian economy slow further.

TRADE-ECONOMY · AFR

AFR: Snowy Hydro due diligence failure symbolises infrastructure record

The failure by Snowy Hydro and the federal government to conduct proper due diligence symbolises Australia's increasingly chequered infrastructure record, the AFR argues, as the Snowy 2.0 chief executive conceded private enterprise would not have tolerated the cost blowouts.

UPCOMING

NOV 28 — **Victorian state election**
DemosAU polling has Labor's primary vote at a record 18 percent and third behind One Nation.

NOV 2026 — **Albanese and Trump mooted meeting during the prime minister's summit run**
First face-to-face engagement since the US midterms, with tariffs and Iran flagged as Australian priorities.

NOV 2026 — **COP31 negotiations, Turkey**
Australia is leading negotiations while facing Pacific criticism of its fossil fuel exports.

NOV 2026 — **New Zealand special vote count concludes**
An estimated 399,000 specials will decide whether Luxon's coalition keeps its one-seat majority.

DEC 2026 — **Fiji's Constitution (Amendment) Bill returns for third reading**
Rabuka has delayed the vote by at least a month and threatened to expel ministers who oppose it.

THE WIRE

PACIFIC-POLITICS

DEVPOLICY BLOG

Measuring anti-corruption success in small Pacific states

Tonga's Anti-Corruption Commissioner **Chris LaHatte** and Office Executive Director **Mele Fakatouato Mangisi** argue counting prosecutions is the wrong way to judge an anti-corruption commission, and set out what Tonga's ACC should measure instead.

NZ-FOREIGN-POLICY

LOWY INTERPRETER

New Zealand's foreign policy could change, but not for weeks

The Lowy Interpreter argues New Zealand's election limbo will cost it a voice at APEC and COP while coalition formation drags on.

PACIFIC-DIPLOMACY

ABC PACIFIC

UN weighs phase-out of seamount bottom trawling

Negotiations on the UN General Assembly Sustainable Fisheries Resolution are concluding with a proposal to phase out bottom trawling on seamounts in international waters by the end of next year, a question of direct consequence for Pacific fisheries states.

TRADE-ECONOMY

AFR

AFR: AI's midterm setback could be Australia's gain

The AFR argues the political backlash against data centres in the United States presents an opportunity for Australia, if politicians and voters accept large-scale facilities with the right regulations.

NZ-POLITICS

AFP

New Zealand's centrist kingmaker says populism is failing voters

AFP reports New Zealand's centrist kingmaker arguing populism is failing voters worldwide, as coalition talks remain unresolved.

CSIS Australia Chair

AUSTRALIA DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

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